

Writing Tools 🛠️

Operation	Keystroke	Function	Note	
Writing Tools - Help & Customize artbollocks-mode writegood-mode wc-mode (counts & goals) writeroom-mode pr-whisper	Several external packages provide supplemental writing tools to what Emacs already provides. See also: 🔗 Spell Checking PEL installs the following external packages when their corresponding pel-use- customizable user-option is turned on (set to t):  artbollocks-mode  pel-use-artbollocks-mode A minor mode to avoid clichés and bad grammar. PEL currently uses my fork.  gt  pel-use-go-translate  Text translator, supports multiple engines: google, Bing, deepL, StarDict, Youdao & LLMs ChatGPT, DeepSeek, etc.. See instructions on Github project readme page. Requires Emacs >= 28  harper-ls  pel-use-harper-ls A minor-mode to use Harper, a locally hosted, privacy-first, fast, open-source grammar checker.  You must manually install the harper-ls server on your system. - Set pel-use-harper-ls user-option to either: - A list of major modes where it must be activated - The value english-prose-mode-plaintext  pr-whisper  pel-use-pr-whisper  Speech-to-text via the Whisper.cpp port of OpenAI Whisper model. All audio is processed locally.  You must manually install Whisper.cpp and other dependencies on your system.  wc-mode  pel-use-wc-mode The wc-mode minor mode counts words with optional word-count goal.  writegood-mode  pel-use-writegood-mode A minor mode to aid in finding common writing problems.  writeroom-mode  pel-use-writeroom-mode A minor-mode that implements distraction-free writing mode.	Last updated on: 2026-09-20	To activate above package in PEL access the pel-pkg-for-writing customization group. Access it with: <f11> W <f2>	
Open this PDF file. See also: 🔗 Help/Info	<f11> W <f1>	(pel-help-pdf &optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)	Open the Writing Tools local PDF. With C-u , M-- , M- -1 or C- -1 prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the pel-flip-help-pdf-arg user-option is set it's the other way around.	
🔗 Customize PEL Writing Tools support	<f11> W <f2>	(pel-customize-pel &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Customize PEL Writing Tools support: open pel-pkg-for-writing-mode group giving access to all pel-use- user options listed above. If OTHER-WINDOW is non-nil (use C-u), display in another window.	
🔗 Customize Emacs Writing Tools support	<f11> W <f3>	(pel-customize-library &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Customize Writing Tools external packages support: artbollocks-mode, gt, wc, writegood, writeroom. If OTHER-WINDOW is non-nil (use C-u), display in another window.	
Toggle artbollocks-mode to highlight various English prose issues	<f11> W a	(artbollocks-mode &optional ARG)	Highlight passive voice, weasel words and artbollocks jargon in text, and provide useful text metrics.  Requires artbollocks-mode  activated by pel-use-artbollocks-mode .  In some cases you might need to force re-fontification win the buffer, by executing: M-x font-lock-fontify-buffer	
Count words in the marked area	C-c [	(artbollocks-word-count &optional START END)	Count the number of words in the marked area or complete buffer and print it in the echo area.	
Count sentences in the marked area	C-c]	(artbollocks-sentence-count &optional START END)	Count the number of sentences in the marked area or complete buffer and print it in the echo area.	
Evaluate the readability index of marked section.	C-c \	(artbollocks-readability-index &optional START END)	Determine the automated readability index of the text or complete buffer in the marked area.	
Evaluate the Flesch reading ease of text in marked section.	C-c /	(artbollocks-reading-ease &optional START END)	Determine the Flesch reading ease of text in the marked area or complete buffer, print the rating in the echo area. Higher scores indicate material that is easier to read.	
Evaluate and print Flesch-Kinkaid grade level of text in the marked	C-c =	(artbollocks-grade-level &optional START END)	Determine the Flesch-Kinkaid grade level of text in the marked area and print it in the echo area.	
Toggle writegood-mode to highlight various English prose issues	<f11> W g g	(writegood-mode &optional ARG)	Colorize issues with the writing in the buffer.  Requires writegood-mode  activated by pel-use-writegood-mode	
Print writegood-mode version	<f11> W g v	(writegood-version)	Print the version of write good-mode.el	
Evaluate the Flesch reading ease of text in marked section.	<f11> W g r	(writegood-reading-ease &optional START END)	Print Flesch reading ease and Flesch-Kinkaid grade level of text in the marked area or complete buffer. Scores roughly between 0 and 100.	
Evaluate and print Flesch-Kinkaid grade level of text in the marked	<f11> W g l	(writegood-grade-level &optional START END)	Flesch-Kincaid grade level test. Converts reading ease score to a grade level (Score ~ years of school needed to read passage).	
Toggle wc-mode (Word Count Mode)	<f11> W c	(wc-mode &optional ARG)	Toggle wc mode (Word Count mode). - When wc-mode is enabled on a buffer, it counts the current words in the buffer and keeps track of a differential of added or subtracted words. - A goal of number of words added/subtracted can be set while using this mode. Upon completion of the goal, the modeline text will highlight indicating that the goal has been reached.	
Set word goal	C-c C-w w	(wc-set-word-goal GOAL)	Set a goal for adding or removing words in the buffer.	
Set line goal	C-c C-w l	(wc-set-line-goal GOAL)	Set a goal for adding or removing lines in the buffer.	
Set character goal	C-c C-w a	(wc-set-char-goal GOAL)	Set a goal for adding or removing chars in the buffer.	
Count words	C-c C-w c	(wc-count &optional RSTART REND FIELD)	Count the words, lines and characters present in the region following point. This function follows most of the rules present in the ‘how-many’ function. If INTERACTIVE is omitted or nil, just return the word count, do not print it. Otherwise, if INTERACTIVE is t, the function behaves according to interactive behavior. - START and END specify the region to operate on. - When called interactively, this function first checks to see if it is in Transient Mark mode. If that is the case, then the function operates over the marked region. Otherwise, it will operate over the entire buffer.	
Toggle writeroom-mode	<f11> W r r	(writeroom-mode &optional ARG)	Minor mode for distraction-free writing.  Requires writeroom-mode  activated by pel-use-writeroom-mode	
Increase width	<f11> W r +	(writeroom-increase-width)	Increase the width of the writing area by 2 characters.	
Decrease width	<f11> W r -	(writeroom-decrease-width)	Decrease the width of the writing area by 2 characters.	
Adjust width	<f11> W r 0	(writeroom-adjust-width AMOUNT)	Adjust the width of the writing area on the fly by AMOUNT. - A numeric prefix argument can be used to specify the adjustment. - When called without a prefix, this will reset the width to the default value	
Toggle display of mode line	<f11> W r m	(writeroom-toggle-mode-line)	Toggle display of the mode line (shows modeline at the top of buffer).  Since this command is allowed while the writeroom-mode is off, you can use it to add a modeline bar at the top of the current window. That window will then have 2 mode lines: one at the top and one at the bottom.	

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Toggle pr-whisper mode  Transcribe speech to text using a AI LLM running locally on your computer. For macOS, see also: 🍏- AppleScript	<f11> W W	(pr-whisper-toggle-recording ARG)	Toggle the pr-whisper recording n/off. - When turned on it starts recording audio in the background. After some audio is recorded you can stop the recording by turning the mode off or using the pr-whisper-stop-record command. Stopping audio recording starts the speech to text transcribing process and the transcribed text is inserted in the buffer that was current at point when recording was started. - If pr-whisper-insert-function user-option is set, use this function to insert the text. - Stopping with a prefix argument (like C-u) stops recording but prevent text insertion in current buffer. - While recording the mode line of the buffer where text will go shows a flashing • REC	
	 Requires pr-whisper  activated by pel-use-pr-whisper - This also requires the SoX library and the Whisper.cpp project. See pr-whisper.cpp home page for information to get and build those. - The AI LLM model used for the analysis is selected by the pr-whisper-model user-option. Several models are provided in the whisper.cpp/model directory that you need to install and build separately.. More models are available at ggerganov/whisper.cpp @ Hugging Face.			
	<f11> W S	(pr-whisper-stop-record &optional use-default-insert	Stop audio recording and insert text at point in current buffer. - If pr-whisper-insert-function user-option is set, use this function to insert the text. - With optional argument (eg. C-u prefix) use the default insertion behaviour.	
Insert transcription from history.	<f11> W H	(pr-whisper-insert-from-history)	Insert a previous transcription from history. - Prompts with completing-read showing transcriptions with their source buffer. - When a transcription is selected, it is promoted to the most recent - position in the history ring, making it less likely to be evicted when the ring reaches capacity.	
Transcribe an already recorded WAV file	<f11> W F	(pr-whisper-transcribe-file FNAME)	Transcribe a recorded audio file FNAME, insert transcribed text at point. 👉 This command can only be used when 'pr-whisper-mode is inactive.	
Use gt text-translation and text-to-speech operations 	 With gt external package  available when pel-use-go-translate is turned on, you can perform text natural language translations and text to speech operations. Requires Emacs >= 28   This uses Internet-based external/remote engines: it sends text to an agent running on the internet to process the text.  This package requires installation of various packages and configuration. The following provides some information about it.			
Engines	osxdict	osx-dictionary	A macOS specific dictionary search executable that uses the macOS command look and a local dictionary file. You can build it from source with the following: <pre>wget https://raw.githubusercontent.com/itchyny/dictionary.vim/refs/heads/master/autoload/dictionary.m clang -framework CoreServices -framework Foundation dictionary.m -o osx-dictionary</pre> Once done put osx-dictionary or a symlink to it inside a directory in your PATH.	
Translate text	<f11> W T T	(gt-translate &optional ARG)	Translate using 'gt-default-translator'.	